Focus States

What is it for?

Focus states occur when an interactive element receives focus. Interactive elements include links, buttons, and input fields. You can focus on an element by clicking it (as long as the click doesn't take you somewhere else). You can also press the Tab key until the element is selected.

Focus states must follow all the usual accessibility guidelines. For instance, if a user with low vision uses a screen magnifier, then they may not be able to see context, so link or button text needs to be descriptive.

How to support it

If you're building or designing a new component, make sure it has focus states that follow all accessibility guidelines (e.g. colour contrast, tap target size, descriptive text, etc.).

Useful links

- Understanding focus state styles
- Wise - Focus states
- Focusing on focus states